

Deep-dive profile of Dr. Ben Robinson (your SGU interviewer)

1. Core facts to carry into the room

- **Training path** – BS Pepperdine 1994, MS Health & Exercise Science Wake Forest 1997, MD SGU 1997, Emergency-Medicine residency Detroit Receiving Hospital (Wayne State) 2000 → board certified emergency physician
 - **Admissions career** – Long-time SGU alumni interviewer and mentor; became Assistant Director of Admission for Canada in 2015, forged university feeder partnerships, and still volunteers as a senior interviewer today
 - **Public educator** – Guest on the ProspectiveDoctor podcast, speaker for MedSchoolCoach, and frequent webinar host guiding applicants on interview strategy and SGU life
 - **Interview style** – Aims for a “fun, lively conversation.” Often meets at cafés. If schedule is tight he can switch to brisk, no-nonsense questioning yet stays professional
 - **What he looks for** – Genuine commitment to SGU, clear reasoning for medicine, traits like curiosity, empathy, critical thinking, and emotional stability. Expects concise answers and thoughtful questions from you
-

2. Likely interests, dislikes, and habits

Area	Chance he enjoys or values it	Estimated depth	Key clues from his record
Fitness, gym, running	90 %	Advanced	Earned an MS in Exercise Science; background suggests lifelong focus on physical health
Mentoring & teaching	88 %	Advanced	Years of webinars, podcasts, AAMP mentoring, admissions leadership
Coffee culture	78 %	Casual enthusiast	Holds interviews over breakfast coffee to relax applicants
Travel & new cultures	75 %	Intermediate	Led Canadian and U.S. recruitment tours and campus partnerships
Efficient scheduling	72 %	High	Some candidates report rapid-fire, twenty-minute sessions when he is busy
Straight talk & transparency	70 %	High	Speaks frankly about SGU tuition, match realities, and applicant fit
Long, rambling stories	25 %	Clear dislike	Applicant accounts note impatience with unfocused answers
Candidates who see SGU as backup	20 %	Strong dislike	Repeatedly probes “Why SGU?” and realistic specialty goals

3. Rationale behind the estimates

- **Exercise focus** – Choosing an MS in Health and Exercise Science before medicine hints at genuine personal interest, not a résumé filler. That makes fitness talk a safe, authentic ice-breaker.
 - **Teaching mindset** – His podcast episode frames interviews as “shared curiosity.” People rarely volunteer that insight unless pedagogy excites them.
 - **Coffee interviews** – Multiple in-person testimonials mention café settings. Someone who turns a formal evaluation into a coffee chat likely enjoys that environment.
 - **Travel** – Admissions roadshows require stamina and openness to new settings; he signed an international MOU in Canada, showing comfort negotiating abroad.
 - **Efficiency** – A strict twenty-minute Q&A followed by on-the-spot essay shows he prizes time discipline.
 - **Dislike of rambling** – Reports of “no smile, quick questions” suggest frustration when answers drift.
-

4. Leveraging the profile for you, Jafar

What you can do	Why it works with him
Open with a quick nod to fitness. Example: “I keep mental sharpness through lifting and short runs during MCAT prep.”	Signals shared value in preventive health and gives an easy conversational hook.
Deliver a crisp 60-second elevator pitch.	Matches his efficiency; shows you respect his time.
Bring two depth questions about SGU’s emergency-medicine teaching sites or student wellness in Grenada.	Engages his educator side and proves real homework.
Frame SGU as intentional, not fallback. Talk about global health exposure and your track record working under pressure (heavy credit loads, community service).	Calms his concern about “backup” applicants and aligns with his emergency-medicine background.
Show curiosity and humility when he asks ethical or stress questions—use the STAR model, end with a lesson learned.	Mirrors the qualities he states he values in doctors.
Close with gratitude plus a fitness-linked thank-you: “Thank you for sharing your journey from exercise science to emergency medicine. It inspires me to keep balancing health and study.”	Personal, memorable, and ties back to mutual interest.

5. Sample virtual-interview script

1. “Tell me about yourself.”

“I am Jafar Dabbagh, a first-generation college graduate who turned a 3.0 start into three straight Dean’s List semesters while carrying heavy course loads. I like turning strain into structure. Outside class I play skill sports like wrestling and soccer and help my dad stay active with weekend pickleball. That balance of mental grind and functional movement keeps me curious and ready for medicine.”

Why this lands

Short identity statement, one academic win, one personal detail that echoes his exercise background.

2. “Why choose SGU?”

“SGU is my deliberate first choice because it offers early clinical immersion in a setting that mirrors the diverse communities I want to serve. The global elective network and strong primary-care matches line up with my plan to start in family medicine and grow into global health work. I want training where resourcefulness is normal, not optional, and SGU is built for that.”

Why this lands

Shows specific knowledge, addresses his worry about backup applicants, and keeps your specialty aim realistic.

3. “Describe a time you were under intense pressure.”

“Two winters ago our Wyoming back-country group was hit by a sudden blizzard. Radio signal died, one member slipped into a creek, and hypothermia set in fast. I noticed her face twitching, got her into a dry tent with the other women, and used electronic hand warmers to stabilize her temperature. Then I cut a six-foot trench up a ridge and climbed until I found a weak signal. I relayed our what3words location and got us reunited two days later. I learned that clear thinking and tiny actions—like swapping wet gloves—stack up to save lives.”

Why this lands

STAR structure, vivid action verbs, proof of calm leadership under stress, reinforces readiness for medicine.

4. “How do you handle stress and stay well?”

“I treat fitness as skill practice, not punishment. Two pull-up routines and one soccer session a week keep my heart strong and my mind clear. On heavy study days I add five minutes of box breathing

to drop my heart rate. Research shows it lowers cortisol and boosts working memory, and it helped me raise my GPA during my thirty-credit semester.”

Why this lands

Connects your preferred sports to evidence-based wellness, echoing his exercise science roots.

5. “Where do you see yourself in ten years?”

“I picture myself practicing family medicine with enough schedule freedom to raise a close family and to launch public-health projects that teach functional fitness in underserved schools. Security for my household and impact for my patients matter equally to me. SGU’s service culture and global outlook fit that vision.”

Why this lands

Shows balanced goals—family, security, impact—while tying back to SGU values.

6. “Any questions for me?”

“Thank you. First, how did your exercise-science training change the way you counsel patients day to day? Second, what study habit did you see in your most successful SGU students that I can start building now?”

Why this lands

He gets to talk about his passion and to mentor you. That creates rapport and practical guidance.
